

3 Practices that shape and express religious identity	3.1	Distinctive practices and emphases of Theravada Buddhism and how they shape and express religious identity a) Its significance as the only surviving form of Nikaya Buddhism. b) Rejection of the idea of the Three Vehicles. c) The centrality of Buddha Gautama, especially in their use of images and stupas. d) The goal of nibbana and parinibbana as a central teaching alongside an emphasis on renunciation, including the four stages to becoming an arahant. e) The distinctive teachings of Theravada; their interpretation and application in light of the life and teachings of the Buddha and other traditions of Buddhism and their different emphases. With reference to the ideas of R Gombrich and H Gunaratana.
	3.2	Distinctive practices and emphases of Mahayana Buddhism and how they shape and express religious identity a) Its development and context in the second century BCE and the first century CE. b) The extension of the concept of the Buddha. The doctrine of the trikaya. c) The Buddha nature in every person. The centrality of Buddha Gautama, especially in their use of images and stupas. The different schools of Mahayana should be explored in the context of the countries in which they developed and are practised. With reference to the ideas of A Basham and the 14th Dalai Lama.
	3.3	The different types and purposes of meditation, their context and application and how they shape and express religious identity a) The different types of meditation in Buddhism. b) The place and context of meditation as part of the eight-fold path, links to wisdom and morality, including the influence of types of meditation on moral development. c) The practice and purpose of dhyana, samatha and vipassana as types of meditation, including accounts of meditation techniques, their purposes and context. d) Understanding of the purposes of meditation in terms of Enlightenment and the relative importance of some aspects of meditation. The practices of chanting, giving and study to understand Buddhism as it is lived by laypeople as well as monastics. With reference to the ideas of T Bhikkhu and J Goldstein.

Topics	What students need to learn	
4 Social and historical developments	4.1	The spread of Buddhism and the impact of migration; with specific reference to developments in China and Japan a) Beliefs and practices of Pure Land and Zen, types of tradition, key people and distinctive emphases, including relevant indigenous traditions and Buddhism's encounter with modernity. b) Key teachings and practices, including the contributions of key people and significant features of relevant scripture. c) Significant features that constitute gradual or more radical changes from earlier traditions, including debates about belief and practice in these respective traditions/schools. With reference to the ideas of S Mochizuki and W T de Bary.
	4.2	The rise of Triratna Buddhism in response to secularisation, Western culture and ideals a) The beliefs and teachings of Triratna Buddhism (formerly Friends of the Western Buddhist Order) in the context of Western society and wider Buddhist beliefs and teachings, including the importance of the three refuges, the unity of the sangha, the importance of spreading the message of Buddhism and the rejection of specific rules within the context of the sangha. b) The success of applying Buddhist teaching in a different culture, and the response of other Buddhist traditions to these developments. With reference to the ideas of Vajragupta and J Coleman.
	4.3	The development of the role of women, and the changing role of men, in different forms of Buddhism a) The significance of Māhapājapatī Gotamī and the development of the role of women in the ordained sangha; the role of men in the sangha. b) Family life and the role of men and women in Buddhism in the dhamma, history and contemporary society. c) Feminist approaches in contemporary Buddhism. With reference to the ideas of N S Salgado and T Bartholomeusz.